

# The Cost of Always Being Busy: The Decision

忙碌的代价：决定

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

## English Story

The decision was taken on the **side** of a **shallow** pool, with a **board** across two stones and a **heavy drop** of rain on the **mat**. “My plan is a **habit**, not an **empire**,” Maya said. “A **quick look** at the **target** tells you who is able to come.” A **bar** of **shade**, a **pint** of **soup**, and a **lemon** in the **fruit** bowl: the committee had provided lunch and nothing else.

The **acute** problem was the **stomach** of a young athlete: a **headache**, a **bulb** of garlic, and a plate of **potato** and **cucumber**. “You cannot **kick** a body into health,” the doctor said. “You can **hang** a **spoon** from a **fork**, but you cannot **hang** a **habit** on a threat.” The **salt**, the **cream**, and the **solid mass** of the diet were all on the table.

The **triangle** of obligations was simple: the national federation, the campus health service, and our own small project. “Follow the body and the bank will follow,” she said. “Kill the pressure and you kill the plan.” The review of the last month showed a fall in injuries and a rise in attendance, and the **crown** of the argument was a story about a **naked** skater on the ice.

The decision was to make rest a formal part of training, with a **mat**, a **mixer**, and a **pump** in the corner of the gym. “An **incline** is not a barrier,” the coach said. “It is a slower way up.” A **nickel** in the vending machine, a pair of **pants** in the locker, and a **filling** in a tooth: the small costs of a large change.

They came to the committee with one sentence and one number: two hours a week, provided free, for every member of the club. The committee asked who would pay, and the answer was our own budget line. “Who loses?” the chair asked. “Nobody who is able to come,” Maya said, “and that is the whole point.” The decision was difficult, and it had to come today; the committee would ask who paid, and my answer was the same as theirs. Able bodies, a bank, a national register: the plan had to provide something that could reach a body before it broke. A **shoulder**, an **apple**, a **skate**, and a music stand: the room had everything except a programme for an **addict** of busyness, and the game would be lost without one.

## 中文翻译

决定是在一片浅水池边做出的，一块木板横在两块石头上，垫子上落着一大滴雨。“我的计划是一种习惯，而不是一个帝国，”曼雅说，“看一眼目标就知道谁能来。”一条荫凉、一品脱汤，以及水果盘里的一只柠檬：委员会提供了午餐，仅此而已。

严峻的问题是那位年轻运动员的胃：头痛、一瓣大蒜，以及一盘土豆和黄瓜。“你无法把一个身体踢向健康，”医生说，“你可以把勺子挂在叉子上，但你无法把一个习惯挂在威胁上。”盐、奶油和那份饮食的坚实分量都摆在桌上。

义务的三角关系很简单：国家联合会、校园健康服务，以及我们自己这个小项目。“跟着身体走，银行就会跟上，”她说，“把压力杀掉，计划也就死了。”上个月的复审显示受伤减少、出勤上升，而这场论证的顶点，是一个关于一位赤裸滑冰者在冰上的故事。

决定是让休息成为训练的正式部分，角落里放一张垫子、一台搅拌机和一台打气筒。“斜坡不是障碍，”教练说，“它是一条更慢的上坡路。”自动售货机里的一枚五分镍币、储物柜里的一条裤子，以及牙上的一处补缀：这场大改变的小代价。

他们带着一句话和一个数字来到委员会：每周两小时，免费提供，面向俱乐部每一位成员。委员会问谁来付钱，答案是我们的预算科目。“谁受损？”主席问。“凡是能来的人都不受损，”曼雅说，“而这正是全部要点。”这个决定很难，而且必须今天做出；委员会会问谁付钱，而我的答案和他们的一样。能行的身体、一家银行、一份全国登记册：这个计划必须提供某种东西，能在一具身体垮掉之前触达它。一副肩膀、一个苹果、一块滑板，以及一个乐谱架：这个房间里什么都有，唯独没有给忙碌成瘾者的方案，而没有它，这场比赛就会输。

## Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

| Word / Pronunciation                 | Context meaning / source example                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>look</b><br>lʊk<br>POS: n         | n. 一看, 神色, 样子, 面容; vi. 看, 注意, 朝着, 显得; vt. 打量, 看上去与...一样, 以眼色(或脸色)显示, 期待<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the act of directing the eyes toward something and perceiving it visually; n. physical appearance; v. perceive...    |
| <b>side</b><br>saɪd<br>POS: n        | n. 旁边, 侧, 方面, 肋, 侧边, 血统; a. 旁的, 侧的, 次要的; vt. 同意, 支持; vi. 支持, 赞助<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a place within a region identified relative to a center or reference location; n. one of two or more contest...              |
| <b>board</b><br>bɔ:d<br>POS: n       | n. 木板, 甲板, 膳食, 会议桌; vt. 乘船, 供膳食, 用板覆盖; vi. 搭伙; [计] 板<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a committee having supervisory powers; n. a stout length of sawn timber; made in a wide variety of sizes and...                         |
| <b>drop</b><br>drɒp<br>POS: n        | n. 滴, 微量, 落下, 空投; vi. 放下, 掉下, 下降; vt. 使滴下, 放下, 丢失, 遗漏; [计] 投入, 投入点, 接入点, ...<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a shape that is spherical and small; n. a small indefinite quantity (especially of a liquid); n. a sudden sh... |
| <b>hang</b><br>hæŋ<br>POS: n         | n. 悬挂, 诀窍, 意义; vt. 悬挂, 附着, 装饰, 垂下, 踌躇, 绞死, 使悬而未决; vi. 悬着, 垂下, 被绞死, 悬而不决<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the way a garment hangs; n. a gymnastic exercise performed on the rings or horizontal bar or parallel bars...        |
| <b>stone</b><br>stəʊn<br>POS: n      | n. 石头, 宝石, 果核, 纪念碑, 结石; vt. 投扔石子, 铺石头; a. 石的, 石制的, 完全的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. building material consisting of a piece of rock hewn in a definite shape for a special purpose; n. an avoir...                        |
| <b>heavy</b><br>'hevi<br>POS: a      | a. 重的, 巨大的, 沉重的, 笨重的, 过度的; adv. 沉重地; n. 重物, 严肃角色<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an actor who plays villainous roles; n. a serious (or tragic) role in a play; a. of comparatively great phys...                             |
| <b>shoulder</b><br>'ʃəʊldə<br>POS: n | n. 肩, 肩膀, 衣肩; vt. 肩负, 负担, 担任; vi. 用肩推挤<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the part of the body between the neck and the upper arm; n. a cut of meat including the upper joint of the...                                         |
| <b>bar</b><br>bɑ:<br>POS: n          | n. 条, 棒, 酒吧, 栅, 障碍物; vt. 禁止, 阻挡, 妨碍; [计] 棒形图<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a counter where you can obtain food or drink; n. a rigid piece of metal or wood; usually used as a fastener...                                  |
| <b>target</b><br>'tɑ:ɡɪt<br>POS: n   | n. 目标, 靶子, 指标; vt. 对准, 订指标<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a reference point to shoot at; n. the location of the target that is to be hit; n. sports equipment consisting...                                                 |
| <b>quick</b><br>kwɪk<br>POS: a       | a. 快的, 迅速的, 敏捷的, 灵敏的, 急速的; adv. 快; n. 新长出的肉, 要害, 核心, 感觉敏锐部位<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. any area of the body that is highly sensitive to pain (as the flesh underneath the skin or a fingernail or...                    |
| <b>salt</b><br>sɔ:lt<br>POS: n       | n. 盐, 风趣, 刺激; a. 含盐的, 咸的, 风趣的, 辛辣的; vt. 加盐于, 用盐腌<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a compound formed by replacing hydrogen in an acid by a metal (or a radical that acts like a metal); n. whi...                              |
| <b>fruit</b><br>fru:t<br>POS: n      | n. 水果, 果类, 结果; [医] 果实, 种实<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the ripened reproductive body of a seed plant; n. the consequence of some effort or action; v. cause to bear...                                                    |
| <b>crown</b><br>kraʊn<br>POS: n      | n. 王冠, 王权, 顶点; vt. 使成王, 加冕, 居...之顶<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the Crown (or the reigning monarch) as the symbol of the power and authority of a monarchy; n. the part of...                                             |
| <b>kick</b><br>kɪk<br>POS: n         | n. 踢, 反冲, 后座力, 凹底; vi. 踢, 反抗, 反冲; vt. 踢, 反冲<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the act of delivering a blow with the foot; n. the sudden stimulation provided by strong drink (or certain...                                    |
| <b>mass</b><br>mæs<br>POS: n         | n. 块, 大多数, 质量, 大量, 群众, 弥撒; a. 群众的, 大规模的, 整个的; vt. 使集合, 集中; vi. 聚集<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the property of a body that causes it to have weight in a gravitational field; n. an ill-structured collect...             |
| <b>cream</b><br>kri:m<br>POS: n      | n. 乳酪, 奶油, 面霜; [医] 乳油, 乳皮; 乳膏, 霜<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the best people or things in a group; n. the part of milk containing the butterfat; n. toiletry consisting o...                                             |
| <b>solid</b><br>'sɒlɪd<br>POS: n     | n. 固体; a. 坚硬的, 稳固的, 固体的, 实心的, 纯质的, 立体的, 立方的; [计] 原色<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. matter that is solid at room temperature and pressure; n. the state in which a substance has no tendency to...                           |
| <b>habit</b><br>'hæbɪt<br>POS: n     | n. 习惯, 嗜好, 习性; vt. 使穿衣<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an established custom; n. (psychology) an automatic pattern of behavior in reaction to a specific situation...                                                        |

| Word / Pronunciation                   | Context meaning / source example                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>empire</b><br>'empaɪə<br>POS: n     | n. 帝国, 帝权<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the domain ruled by an emperor or empress; the region over which imperial dominion is exercised; n. a group...                                                              |
| <b>potato</b><br>pə'teɪtəʊ<br>POS: n   | n. 马铃薯<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an edible tuber native to South America; a staple food of Ireland; n. annual native to South America having...                                                                 |
| <b>apple</b><br>'æpl<br>POS: n         | n. 苹果, 家伙; [医] 苹果<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. fruit with red or yellow or green skin and sweet to tart crisp whitish flesh; n. native Eurasian tree wide...                                                       |
| <b>stomach</b><br>'stʌmək<br>POS: n    | n. 胃, 食欲, 欲望, 肚子; vt. 吃下, 忍受<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an enlarged and muscular saclike organ of the alimentary canal; the principal organ of digestion; n. an inc...                                           |
| <b>shade</b><br>ʃeɪd<br>POS: n         | n. 荫, 阴暗, 遮光物, 灯罩, 帘, 浓淡, 微量, 底纹; vi. 渐变; vt. 使阴暗, 使渐变, 遮蔽, 微减; [计] 底纹<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. relative darkness caused by light rays being intercepted by an opaque body; n. a quality of a given color t... |
| <b>soup</b><br>su:p<br>POS: n          | n. 汤, 马力; vt. 加速, 增加马力<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. liquid food especially of meat or fish or vegetable stock often containing pieces of solid food; n. any com...                                                 |
| <b>lemon</b><br>'lemən<br>POS: n       | n. 柠檬, 柠檬树, 柠檬色; [医] 柠檬<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. yellow oval fruit with juicy acidic flesh; n. a small evergreen tree that originated in Asia but is widely...                                                 |
| <b>naked</b><br>'neɪkɪd<br>POS: a      | a. 裸体的, 无装饰的, 无保护的, 赤贫的; [医] 裸露的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. having no protecting or concealing cover; s. (of the eye or ear e.g.) without the aid of an optical or acou...                                       |
| <b>acute</b><br>ə'kjʊ:t<br>POS: a      | a. 尖锐的, 敏锐的, 激烈的, 严重的, 急性的; [医] 急性的; 尖锐的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: a. having or experiencing a rapid onset and short but severe course; s. extremely sharp or intense; s. having o...                              |
| <b>pump</b><br>pʌmp<br>POS: n          | n. 抽水机, 打气筒, 泵, 抽吸; vt. 用唧筒抽水, 打气, 盘问, 倾注, 使疲惫; vi. 抽水, 上下(或往复)运动<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a mechanical device that moves fluid or gas by pressure or suction; n. a low-cut shoe without fastenings; v. ...    |
| <b>fork</b><br>fɔ:k<br>POS: n          | n. 叉子, 叉状物, 分岔; vi. 分支, 分歧; vt. 做成叉形, 叉起; [计] 派生指令<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. cutlery used for serving and eating food; n. the region of the angle formed by the junction of two branches...                     |
| <b>pint</b><br>paɪnt<br>POS: n         | n. 品脱(干量或液量的单位); [医] 量磅, 品脱<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a British imperial capacity measure (liquid or dry) equal to 4 gills or 568.26 cubic centimeters; n. a Unit...                                            |
| <b>shallow</b><br>'ʃæləʊ<br>POS: n     | n. 水浅的地方, 浅滩; a. 浅的, 肤浅的; v. (使)变浅<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. make shallow; v. become shallow; a. lacking physical depth; having little spatial extension downward or inwa...                                    |
| <b>spoon</b><br>spu:n<br>POS: n        | n. 匙, 调羹, 匙形工具; vt. 以匙舀起, 调情, 使成匙状<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a piece of cutlery with a shallow bowl-shaped container and a handle; used to stir or serve or take up foo...                                      |
| <b>headache</b><br>'hedeɪk<br>POS: n   | n. 头痛, 令人头痛之事; [医] 头痛<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. pain in the head caused by dilation of cerebral arteries or muscle contractions or a reaction to drugs                                                          |
| <b>bulb</b><br>bʌlb<br>POS: n          | n. 球茎, 电灯泡; [医] 球, 鳞茎, 球茎<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a modified bud consisting of a thickened globular underground stem serving as a reproductive structure; n. ...                                              |
| <b>triangle</b><br>'traɪæŋgl<br>POS: n | n. 三角形, 三个一组, 三角关系; [医] 三角, 三角形<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a three-sided polygon; n. something approximating the shape of a triangle; n. any of various triangular draf...                                       |
| <b>mat</b><br>mæt<br>POS: n            | n. 垫, 丛, 衬边; a. 粗糙的, 无光泽的; vi. 纠缠在一起; vt. 铺席于...上, 使无光泽, 使缠结<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a thick flat pad used as a floor covering; n. mounting consisting of a border or background for a picture; n...          |
| <b>skate</b><br>skeɪt<br>POS: n        | n. 溜冰, 冰鞋; vi. 滑冰, 滑过<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. sports equipment that is worn on the feet to enable the wearer to glide along and to be propelled by the a...                                                   |
| <b>addict</b><br>ə'dɪkt<br>POS: vt     | vt. 使沉溺, 使上瘾; n. 入迷的人, 上瘾者<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. someone who is so ardently devoted to something that it resembles an addiction; n. someone who is physiolog...                                             |

| Word / Pronunciation                    | Context meaning / source example                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>filling</b><br>'filiŋ<br>POS: n      | n. 充填物, 填料; [化] 加填; 填充<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. any material that fills a space or container; n. flow into something (as a container); n. a food mixture use...                                     |
| <b>pants</b><br>pænts<br>POS: n         | n. 裤子, 长裤, 短裤, 女式运动短裤<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. underpants worn by women; n the noise made by a short puff of steam (as from an engine); n (usually in the pl...                                     |
| <b>nickel</b><br>'nikl<br>POS: n        | n. 镍, 镍币, 五分镍币; vt. 镀镍于<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a hard malleable ductile silvery metallic element that is resistant to corrosion; used in alloys; occurs i...                                      |
| <b>cucumber</b><br>'kju:kəmbe<br>POS: n | n. 黄瓜; [医] 黄瓜, 胡瓜<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a melon vine of the genus Cucumis; cultivated from earliest times for its cylindrical green fruit; n. cylin...                                           |
| <b>mixer</b><br>'mikse<br>POS: n        | n. 混合者, 混合器, 搅拌机, 搅拌器, 混频器, (非正式) 交际家, 与人相处的人; [计] 混频器, 音装置<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. club soda or fruit juice used to mix with alcohol; n. electronic equipment that mixes two or more input sig... |
| <b>incline</b><br>in'klein<br>POS: n    | n. 倾斜, 斜坡, 斜面; vt. 使倾向于, 使倾斜; vi. 倾向, 倾斜, 爱好, 易于<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. bend or turn (one's ear) towards a speaker in order to listen well; v. lower or bend (the head or upper bod...            |